

YOU HAVE ONLY 2 MOVES

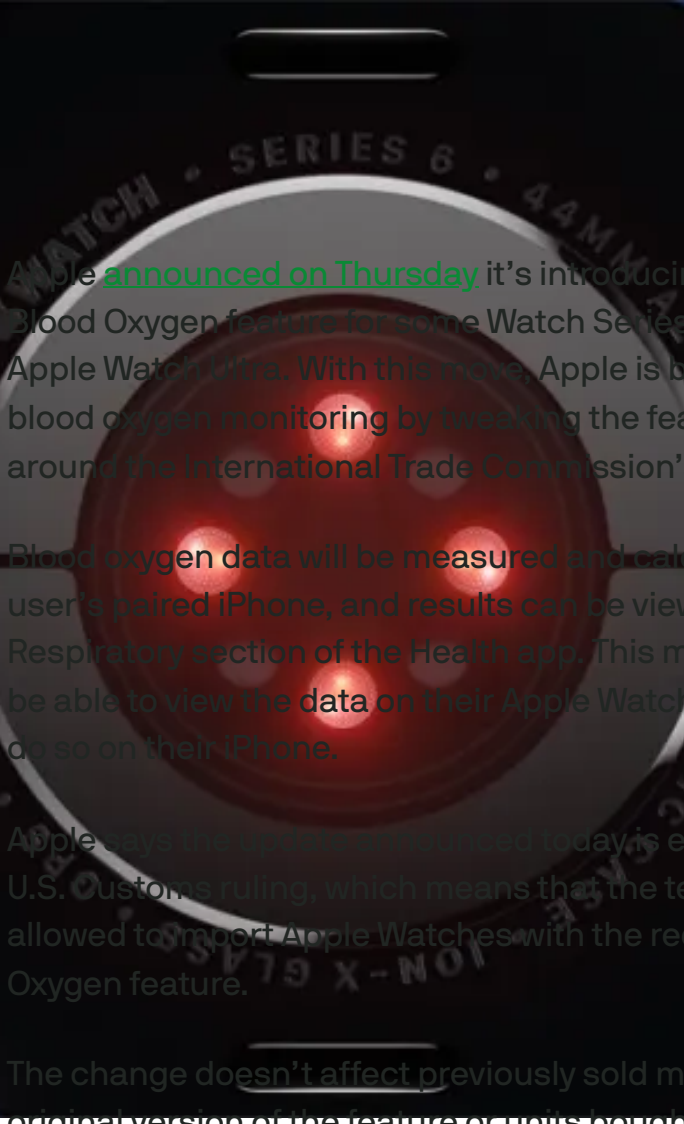
IQ: 155



HARDWARE



Apple's blood oxygen monitoring returns to its latest Apple Watches



Apple [announced on Thursday](#) it's introducing a redesigned Blood Oxygen feature for some Watch Series 8, Series 10, and Apple Watch Ultra. With this move, Apple is bringing back blood oxygen monitoring by tweaking the feature to get around the International Trade Commission's (ITC) import ban.

Blood oxygen data will be measured and calculated on the user's paired iPhone, and results can be viewed in the Respiratory section of the Health app. This means users won't be able to view the data on their Apple Watch, as they'll need to do so on their iPhone.

Apple says the update announced today is enabled by a recent U.S. Customs ruling, which means that the tech giant is allowed to import Apple Watches with the redesigned Blood Oxygen feature.

The change [doesn't affect](#) previously sold models with the original version of the feature or units bought outside the U.S.

IMAGE CREDITS: APPLE

The redesigned feature only applies to Apple Watches that were sold after the ITC import ban took effect in early 2024. These users can access the redesigned Blood Oxygen feature through an iPhone and Apple Watch software update coming on Thursday.

The move comes as Apple has been in an ongoing legal dispute with medical device maker Masimo, which has accused the tech giant of stealing its pulse oximetry technology after initial talks about a potential collaboration.

In 2023, Masimo [secured a victory against Apple](#) at the ITC to block imports of Apple Watches with blood oxygen monitoring, after the commission found that Apple's technology infringed upon Masimo's patents. Apple then had to remove the feature.

DISRUPT

October 27-29, 2025 | San Francisco

Put your brand in front of 10,000+ tech and VC leaders across all three days of Disrupt 2025. Amplify your reach, spark real connections, and lead the innovation charge. Secure your exhibit space before your competitor does.

[Book Your Table >](#)

Most Popular



- HR giant Workday says hackers stole personal data in recent breach
- How your solar rooftop became a national security issue
- A comprehensive list of 2025 tech layoffs
- Co-founder of Elon Musk's xAI departs the company
- Google CEO adds a new calendar feature at Stripe co-founder's request
- NASA has sparked a race to develop the data pipeline to Mars
- Why I finally left Spotify

TC

Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital, Elad Gil — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the

insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$600+ before prices rise.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

REGISTER NOW

Apple [counter-sued Masimo](#), claiming that the company copied Apple Watch features to use in its own smartwatches. The tech giant has also [filed an appeal](#) of the ITC ban.

We're always looking to evolve, and by providing some insight into your perspective and feedback into TechCrunch and our coverage and events, you can help us! Fill out [this survey](#) to let us know how we're doing and get the chance to win a prize in return!

Topics: [Apple](#) [Apple Watch](#) [Biotech & Health](#) [Hardware](#)



Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter |

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporter at MobileSyrup. Aisha...

[View Bio](#) >

KEEP READING

HARDWARE





iPhone 17, the ‘thinnest iPhone ever,’ and everything else we’re expecting out of Apple’s hardware event

Lauren Forristal — 9:20 AM PDT · August 18, 2025

Apple usually announces its new hardware in the fall, and this year is likely no different. The event is reported to be on September 9, and Apple is expected to release its iPhone 17 lineup, along with updates for the Apple Watch and AirPods.

As always, there are many rumors circulating, including bigger screens and improved cameras for the iPhone 17 models and the introduction of an ultra-thin iPhone Air that could replace the Plus model.

IMAGE CREDITS: CHENG XIN / GETTY IMAGES

iPhone 17, 17 Pro, and 17 Pro Max

The iPhone 17 is expected to get a significant makeover to align more closely with the Pro models. It could feature a slightly larger [6.3-inch screen](#), which is an increase of 0.2 inches compared to the iPhone 16, as well as a [120Hz display](#), a substantial upgrade from the current 60Hz. It’s also rumored to have a 24-megapixel front camera. It could also come in new colors: purple and green.

iPhone 17: Purple and Green Colors in Testing as Potential New Shade for 2025

Full Article: <https://t.co/jZJJoUHBsf>
[pic.twitter.com/1in8R6dDa5](https://t.co/jZJJoUHBsf)

— Majin Bu (@MajinBuOfficial) [June 20, 2025](#)

Advertisement

Newsletters

[See More ↗](#)

Subscribe for the industry’s biggest tech news

TechCrunch Daily News



Every weekday and Sunday, you can get the best of TechCrunch’s coverage.

Startups Weekly



Startups are the core of TechCrunch, so get our best coverage delivered weekly.

The Pro's upgrades will be noticeable on the back of the phone, rumors suggest. [Conceptual renderings](#) show that the three rear cameras may be arranged in a rectangular bar that extends from one edge of the device to the other. The flash, light sensor, and microphone would be positioned far to the right side. Where the MagSafe charger is, the Apple logo is said to be centered for aesthetic reasons.

Notably, the iPhone 17 Pro may switch materials, potentially replacing the titanium band around the screen with aluminum. This could help Apple reduce costs as well as provide a lighter feel.

The iPhone 17 Pro Max is expected to see fewer upgrades, too, with the most significant change being a slightly thicker body, likely to accommodate a larger battery — which would be a huge win.

According to [leaker Instant Digital](#), the iPhone 17 is predicted to be priced around \$800, and the Pro Max is expected to have a price tag of \$1,250. New colors for the Pro models potentially include [dark blue and copper](#).



Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital, Elad Gil — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$600+ before prices rise.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

REGISTER NOW

The Pro model is expected to be priced around \$1,050. However, a [recent leak](#) indicates that there will be fewer storage options compared to the 16 Pro. Users may lose the 128GB option and will only have three choices: 256GB, 512GB, or 1TB, down from the typical four options.

TechCrunch Week in Review



Get the best of our coverage, delivered to your inbox every Saturday.

TechCrunch Mobility



TechCrunch Mobility is your destination for transportation news and insight.

No newsletters selected.

Email address

Subscribe

By submitting your email, you agree to our [Terms](#) and [Privacy Notice](#).

Advertisement

iPhone Air



IMAGE CREDITS:APPLE TRACK

The most widely discussed rumor is that Apple might be introducing its slimmest phone ever, [the iPhone Air](#), which may replace the iPhone Plus.

This rumored device is said to have a profile thickness of 5.5 mm, making it about 0.08 inches thinner than current iPhones. It'll also feature a 6.6-inch screen.

This move appears to be Apple's response to the trend of slimmer smartphones, following in the footsteps of other companies like Samsung and Huawei. The iPhone Air could potentially outshine the Samsung Galaxy S25 Edge, which measures 5.8 mm thick. Additionally, it may pave the way for [Apple's long-rumored foldable phone](#), predicted to launch in September 2026.

While the thin design is stylish, it would come with some compromises. Based on the [renders](#) we've seen, the Air is expected to have only one rear camera lens, unlike the Plus, which has two. There are also [rumors](#) that there may not be enough space for a speaker at the bottom, meaning the only audio source could be the front earpiece at the top.

Reports suggest the device will be priced at \$950 and will be available in black, silver, and light gold.

Apple Watch Series 11, Ultra 3, and SE 3



IMAGE CREDITS:APPLE

After a two-year wait, there are various rumors surrounding the Apple Watch Ultra 3, suggesting it will undergo significant changes. These may include faster charging speeds, 5G support, and satellite connectivity. Additionally, it's speculated that the watch will feature a [larger display](#).

One of the most exciting potential upgrades for both the Ultra 3 and Series 11 is the incorporation of blood pressure monitoring capabilities. This feature would notify users if their blood pressure levels are too high or too low. Apple is also considering adding a sleep apnea feature. However, according to Bloomberg's Mark Gurman, the company [may need to delay the release of these features for further tweaks](#).

Apple recently announced that a [redesigned blood oxygen feature](#) is rolling out to some Series 8, 10, and Ultra watches. This leads us to think the Ultra 3 may also get the capability, but the company didn't mention if it would be available in the watchOS 26 in its announcement.

The third generation of Apple Watch SE isn't expected to receive major updates, aside from possibly a larger display. There continue to be reports of a plastic version being introduced, according to Gurman.

Rumored prices for the watches are: \$250 for the Apple Watch SE 3, \$400 for the Series 11, and \$800 for the Ultra 3.

AirPods Pro 3



IMAGE CREDITS: APPLE

After the release of the AirPods Pro 2 in 2022, it's about time for an upgrade, and Apple might just be ready to deliver. [Rumors](#) suggest that the AirPods Pro 3 will feature a sleeker design, touch-sensitive controls, smaller earbuds, and a slimmer case. Additionally, the H3 chip is expected to enhance active noise cancellation and adaptive audio.

This story has been updated to include additional rumors.

We're always looking to evolve, and by providing some insight into your perspective and feedback into TechCrunch and our coverage and events, you can help us! Fill out [this survey](#) to let us know how we're doing and get the chance to win a prize in return!

Topics: [Apple](#) [Apple Event](#) [Hardware](#) [iPhone](#)

[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [🐼](#) [✉](#) [🔗](#)



Lauren Forristal



Lauren covers media, streaming, apps and platforms at TechCrunch.

You can contact or verify outreach from Lauren by emailing...

[View Bio](#) >

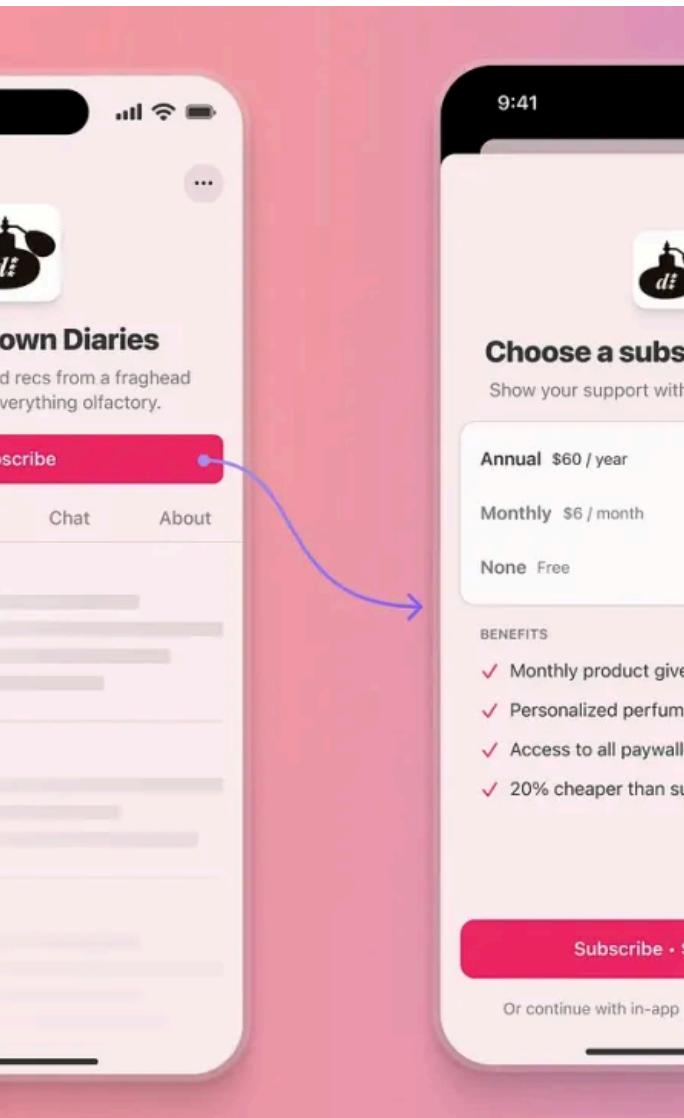


IMAGE CREDITS: SUBSTACK

APPS



Substack writers can now direct US readers to (often cheaper) web-based subscriptions on iOS

Sarah Perez — 10:16 AM PDT · August 18, 2025

Newsletter subscription platform Substack will begin taking advantage of an option on the U.S. App Store that allows users to make purchases outside of Apple's in-app purchasing system. This functionality is permitted by a [change to the App Store's rules in May](#), as a result of [Epic Games' antitrust lawsuit](#) against the tech giant.

Since then, a number of top apps have moved to offer in-app purchase links that point to their own websites, including [Spotify](#), [Patreon](#), and the [Amazon Kindle](#) app, among others.

Latest

Security

Startups

AI

Venture

Apps

Apple

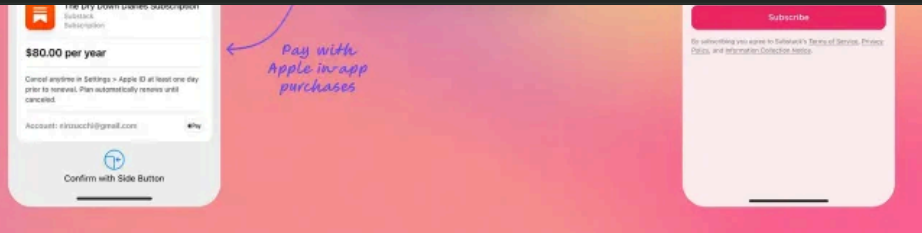
[Events](#)[Podcasts](#)[Newsletters](#)

IMAGE CREDITS: SUBSTACK

Substack explains it will automatically adjust its customers' iOS app price higher to account for Apple's fees, allowing creators to take home the same amount of money as a web subscription. However, Substack writers can disable this feature if they choose. (Substack will continue to take its own 10% fee based on the web subscription price, as before.)

The company said in its blog post that it's also offering its writers "migration tools." We originally reported that these could help migrate users from one payments platform to another, but Substack reached out to correct this. Instead, it said that the tools are meant to help creators access billing information for Apple-managed subscriptions if they ever leave the platform.

Currently, more than 30,000 publications on the platform have in-app purchases enabled; Substack says early tests of the expanded set of payment options have driven a boost in paid sign-ups. It did not, however, share specific numbers related to this.



Latest in Apps

[See More](#)

APPS



TikTok's latest feature lets college students find and connect with classmates

Aisha Malik - 3 hours ago

APPS



Spotify's latest feature lets you add your own transitions to playlists

Sarah Perez - 6 hours ago

APPS



OpenAI launches a sub-\$5 ChatGPT plan in India

Ivan Mehta - 12 hours ago

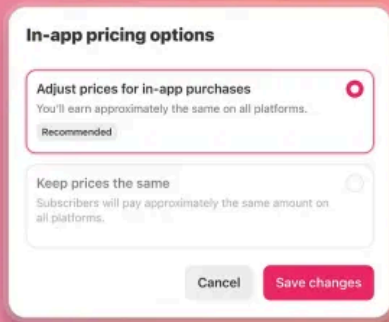


IMAGE CREDITS: SUBSTACK

The public launch of the external payments option will only impact new Substack subscriptions. Substack writers don't have to take any action unless they want to lower the prices for those using Apple's payments system.

Per Apple's App Store rules, fully opting out of offering IAP is not allowed.

While the changes impact the Substack app in the U.S., the company says it's still evaluating if it makes sense to switch to the more complex rules Apple offers in the EU and U.K. for developers who want to forgo IAP.

Updated after publication to correct and clarify how the migration tools work.

We're always looking to evolve, and by providing some insight into your perspective and feedback into TechCrunch and our coverage and events, you can help us! Fill out [this survey](#) to let us know how we're doing and get the chance to win a prize in return!

Topics: [Apple](#) [Apps](#) [Apps](#) [iOS apps](#) [Substack](#)

[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [t](#) [✉](#) [🔗](#)



Sarah Perez

Consumer News Editor | [X](#) [t](#) [@](#) [in](#)

Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having previously spent over three years at...



IMAGE CREDITS: GOOGLE

HARDWARE

Facebook, X, LinkedIn, Reddit, Email, and a link icon.

Pixel 10, AI capabilities, and everything else we expect out of the Made by Google 2025 event

Lauren Forristal — 9:30 AM PDT · August 18, 2025

As anticipation builds for the [Made by Google 2025 event](#), there’s a buzz around the Pixel 10 series, arriving notably before the [iPhone 17](#). Apple’s [hardware event](#) is expected to take place in September.

The tech giant has made its intentions clear to grow the Pixel line, likely incorporating more generative AI capabilities with Gemini. Made by Google starts at 10 a.m. PT on Wednesday.

Get ready for a Gemini boost

TECH DISRUPT

October 27-29, 2025 | San Francisco

Put your brand in front of 10,000+ tech and VC leaders across all three days of Disrupt 2025. Amplify your reach, spark real connections, and lead the innovation charge. Secure your exhibit space before your competitor does.

Book Your Table >





IMAGE CREDITS: THOMAS FULLER/SOPA IMAGES/LIGHTROCKET / GETTY IMAGES

Google already dropped several AI-related updates at its [developer conference](#) in May, but the company will likely demonstrate more Gemini features during the Pixel 10 event. In a recent [YouTube video](#) promoting the new devices, Google even seemed to poke fun at Apple’s failed promises with Apple Intelligence advancements on the iPhone.

[Rumors](#) are buzzing about a feature called “Camera Coach,” which would let Gemini give you real-time tips for taking better photos. The AI is supposedly able to see what’s going on and suggest the best angles and lighting for your shot.

There’s also talk of a [conversational photo editing tool](#), where you tell Gemini what you want to tweak in a photo, such as increasing the brightness, removing objects, or changing the background.

Google Pixel 10 | Soon



Pixel 10, 10 Pro, and 10 Pro XL

Most Popular



- [HR giant Workday says hackers stole personal data in recent breach](#)
- [How your solar rooftop became a national security issue](#)
- [A comprehensive list of 2025 tech layoffs](#)
- [Co-founder of Elon Musk’s xAI departs the company](#)
- [Google CEO adds a new calendar feature at Stripe co-founder’s request](#)
- [NASA has sparked a race to develop the data pipeline to Mars](#)
- [Why I finally left Spotify](#)

The standard Pixel 10 phone is expected to undergo significant changes, particularly with the addition of a dedicated telephoto lens, a feature that was previously exclusive to the Pro models. Following the leak of renders showcasing the third rear lens, [Google released a teaser for the Pixel 10](#), confirming the substantial camera upgrade.

Additionally, all phones in the lineup are expected to be powered by a new Tensor G5 processor, ushering in the Gemini era and enhancing performance and power efficiency compared to the Tensor G4 chip.



Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital, Elad Gil — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$600+ before prices rise.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

REGISTER NOW

IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

Aside from these updates, not many obvious changes appear to be on the table. The basic design of the phones will likely remain similar to that of the Pixel 9 series. The displays are also expected to stay the same, with the Pixel 10 and Pixel 10 Pro

featuring a 6.3-inch display, and the Pixel 10 Pro XL with a larger 6.8-inch display.

Some areas where the Pro models may see improvement are camera and video quality, along with battery size, which could allow for faster charging and could address the longevity gap between Pixel and flagship phones from Apple and Samsung.

Plus, there is talk that the Pixel 10 series could support [Qi2 wireless charging](#). If true, this means it would be one of the few Android phones to work with magnetic accessories, such as chargers, wallets, and mounts. Google is also reportedly launching a “PixelSnap” phone case with a magnetic ring in the center.

Pixel 10 Pro Fold

As for Google’s upcoming foldable, there are rumors suggesting it’ll have a larger cover display, measuring at around 6.4 inches, alongside an 8-inch main screen. Additionally, Google is reportedly enhancing the strength of the hinge, and the bezels are expected to be thinner for a sleek appearance.

Another exciting rumor is the possibility of an [IP68 rating](#), a first for the device. (And according to leaked specs, [this may in fact be coming](#).) This means it can stand up to both dust and water, whereas the Pixel 9 Pro Fold has zero dust protection.

... pic.twitter.com/iJdzbRaDgK

— Evan Blass (@evleaks) [August 7, 2025](#)

Like the other Pixel 10 phones, the Pro Fold will likely be powered by the new G5 chip and include the latest Gemini AI features. The camera system might also receive improvements, potentially featuring a 48-megapixel ultra-wide lens and a telephoto lens with 5x optical zoom. The phone should also likely get a bump in battery life.

The Pixel 10 may come in Moonstone and Jade colors.

The Pixel Watch and Pixel Buds

IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

Wearables will also get their time to shine at Google's event, with the Pixel Watch 4 rumored to get a thicker design, a longer battery life, and smaller bezels.

There's also a strong likelihood that the smartwatch will introduce new health and fitness-tracking capabilities, possibly including an upgraded [blood oxygen \(SpO2\) monitoring](#) function.

[Leaks](#) of the Pixel Buds 2a indicate that the earbuds will come in new colors (Fog Light, Hazel, Iris, and Strawberry) along with [features](#) like active noise cancellation. The Pixel Buds Pro 2 will also reportedly come in a new Sterling color.

This story has been updated to include additional rumors.

We're always looking to evolve, and by providing some insight into your perspective and feedback into TechCrunch and our coverage and events, you can help us! Fill out [this survey](#) to let us know how we're doing and get the chance to win a prize!

Topics: [Google](#) [Google Pixel](#) [Hardware](#) [Made by Google](#)

Advertisement



Lauren Forristal



Lauren covers media, streaming, apps and platforms at TechCrunch.

You can contact or verify outreach from Lauren by emailing...

[View Bio](#) >

Loading the next article



[TechCrunch](#)

[Staff](#)

[Contact Us](#)

[Advertise](#)

[Crunchboard
Jobs](#)

[Site Map](#)

[Terms of
Service](#)

[Privacy Policy](#)

[RSS Terms of
Use](#)

[Neuralink](#)

[Google Chrome](#)

[StubHub](#)

[Claude](#)

[GPT-5](#)

[Tech Layoffs](#)

[ChatGPT](#)